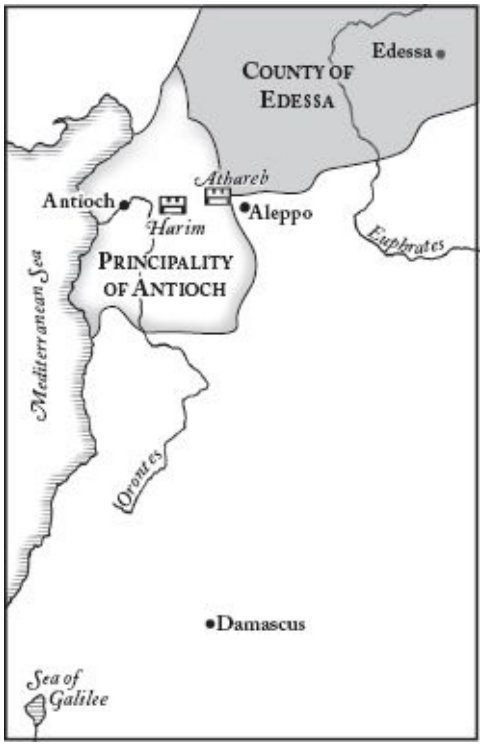
year before, leaving Jerusalem in the hands of a powerless child. The Byzantine emperor John Comnenus had just died of a lingering hunting wound, and his son and heir, Manuel, was occupied with putting down the usual plots and revolts that accompanied the passing of the Byzantine crown. And Raymond, the Prince of Antioch (a Frankish nobleman who had claimed the title by marrying, at the age of twenty-two, the ten-year-old daughter of Bohemund II), refused to send help to his brother Crusader simply because he and Edessa's king were on terms of "insatiable hatred."[6]

In just four short weeks, Edessa fell. The attackers "put to the sword all whom they encountered," man, woman, and child; many who escaped the sword were crushed as they attempted to flee into the last safe citadel.[7]

With the fall of Edessa, the language of *jihad*—of right and just struggle against an unrighteous enemy—ramped sharply upwards. Zengi, who now took for the first time a royal title, became known by a whole series of honorifics: *the ornament of Islam, the help of the believer, God-helped king*. "He will turn tomorrow towards Jerusalem!" wrote the poet Ibn Munir, summing up the hopes of the faithful.[8]



5.1 Aleppo and the Crusader Kingdoms

In the west, the news of Edessa's fall inspired a new crusade.

The call itself came from Pope Eugenius III, in the papal decree (or "bull") *Quantum praedecessores*, and it was designed to recall past glories.